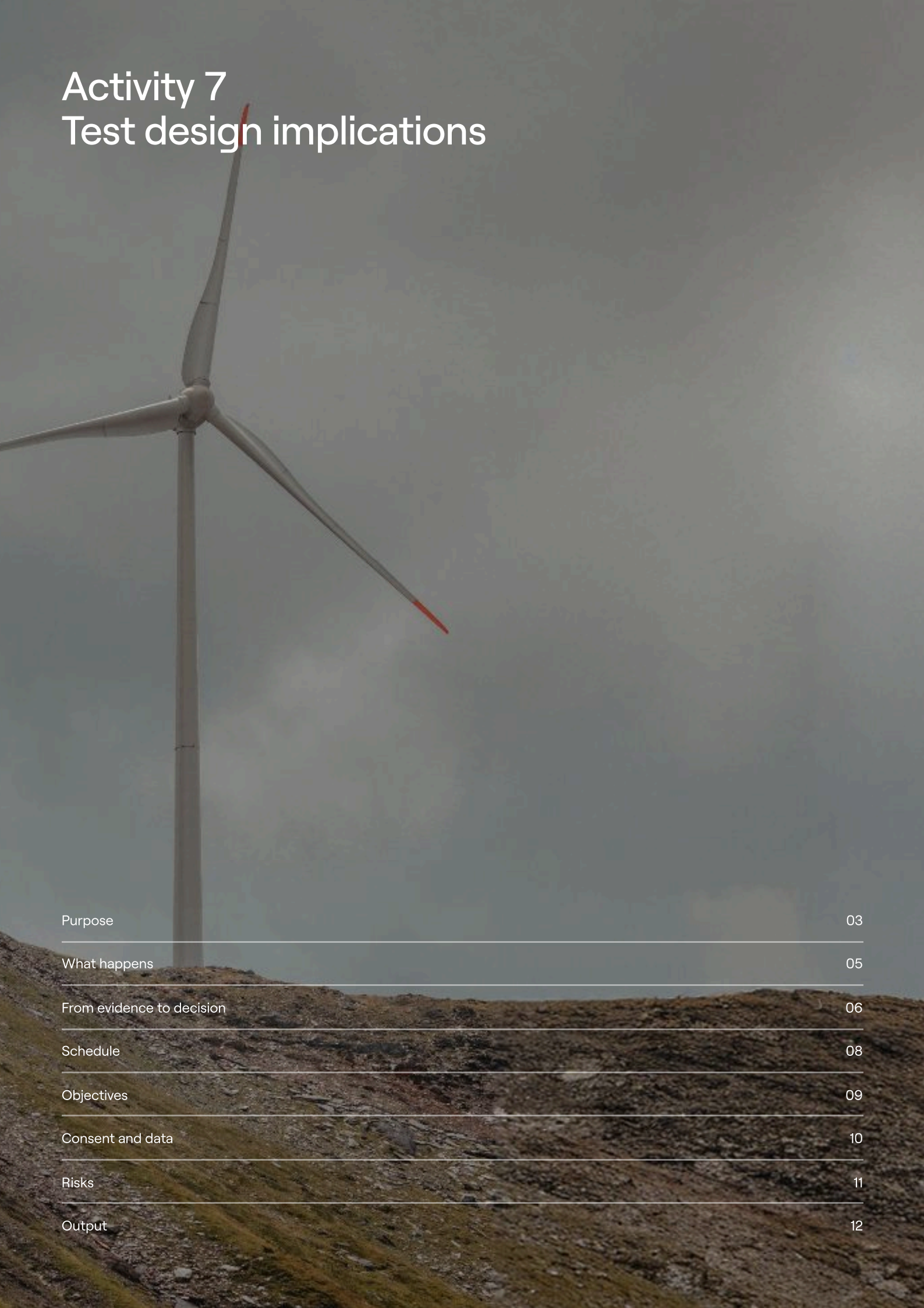
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Test design implications

Astral customer discovery
Activity 7 of 7 · Draft for review · October 2026

Activity 7
Test design implications



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ACTIVITY 7 OF 7

Test design implications

Check whether proposed changes address the needs we found.

PROVISIONAL DURATION

2 to 3 weeks

DEPENDS ON

Priority hypotheses. Prototype ready

OUTPUT

Evidence about which changes work, which do not, and what to try next.

OBJECTIVES IT SERVES

- 7. **Evaluate** whether proposed design changes address the needs we find.

THE SEVEN ACTIVITIES

1	Agree scope and decisions
2	Set up recruitment
3	Discovery round 1
4	Discovery round 2, targeted
5	Survey
6	Integrate and follow up
7	**Test design implications**

PRIMARY RESEARCH QUESTION

How do IMSERV customers do their energy-data work today, and which differences in that work should change how Astral is designed and prioritised?

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What happens

What happens

Check whether proposed changes address the needs we found.

1

Form design hypotheses

Turn priority problems into design hypotheses.

2

Test with matching customers

Test with customers who match the relevant archetypes.

3

Record what serves an objective

Record task success, effort, and confidence where they serve an objective.

From evidence to decision

Each decision follows one chain, so it stays traceable into BA work. Observation, interpretation, and recommendation stay separate, with links back to the evidence.

STEP 1 Evidence	STEP 2 User need	STEP 3 Journey problem
STEP 4 Design hypothesis	STEP 5 Story and acceptance criteria	STEP 6 Evaluation

THE TEST FOR EVERY ARCHETYPE

Would this profile change how we design, prioritise, or evaluate a real task?

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Plan and safeguards

Where it sits

Estimates to agree, not commitments. Bars show the upper estimate for each stage. With overlap, roughly 12 to 18 weeks from agreement to tested implications.



Stage	Provisional duration	Depends on
7. Test design implications	2 to 3 weeks	Priority hypotheses. Prototype ready

Objective-to-evidence

How this activity answers the objectives. Measures serve an objective. They are not collected for their own sake.

Objective	Research question	Evidence	Measure
7. Evaluate	Do proposed changes meet the need?	Observed tasks	Task success, effort, confidence

Neutral draft. No consent wording is sent until it is approved. Legal review before it reaches a participant.

Consent, privacy and data

Agreed with IMSERV's privacy and data-protection owner before the first session.

Every session

- Informed consent for every participant before the session
- Recording, transcription, storage, retention, and any AI processing agreed with IMSERV's privacy and data-protection owner before the first session
- Approved storage with restricted access. Raw recordings and transcripts stay restricted
- Customer documents shown in walkthroughs are redacted or not kept, as agreed
- Participants are P01, P02 in analysis. Removing names alone may not anonymise a distinctive business account
- Quotes in shared outputs only with consent for anonymised quotation
- No consent wording is sent until it is approved. The current wording is a neutral draft

How AI is used

Copilot can help organise approved material, suggest candidate patterns, and keep evidence links up to date. Only within what the privacy owner approves.

It will **not** invent quotes, build archetypes from job titles, or treat simulated customers as evidence.

Risks and limits

What could weaken the evidence, and what we do about it.

Risk	Effect	Mitigation
Prototype screens steer discovery	We confirm our own design	No screens until stage 7

Evidence about which changes work, which do not, and what to try next.

Output

Early findings reach the BA team from round 1, not only at the end.

Hands over to

Prioritised UX decisions.

Each one traceable to evidence, and ready for the BA team to turn into stories.

Working alongside the BA team

- Round 1 findings are shared with the BA team as they emerge, marked provisional
- Stories link back to the need and evidence behind them
- The BA team (Claire and others) can bring open story questions into round 2



Thank You

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